

AGENTIC AI HACKATHON

Tech Zephyr 4.0 | IIT Bhubaneswar

1. Eligibility

- Open to AI enthusiasts and students from all institutions and academic backgrounds.
- Interdisciplinary and cross-institutional participation is allowed.
- Participants must fulfil all registration requirements specified by the organizers.

2. Team Formation

- Teams must consist of **1–4 members**.
- Each participant can be a member of **only one team**.
- Team members must be finalized during registration.
- Any change in team composition after the registration deadline requires approval from the Organizing Committee.
- A participant cannot contribute to multiple competing teams.

3. Competition Format

The hackathon will be conducted in **two stages**:

Stage 1 — Online Submission Round

Teams will submit their Agentic AI solution for evaluation.

Stage 2 — Grand Finale

Shortlisted teams will compete in an **offline Grand Finale at IIT Bhubaneswar**.

A new problem statement will be provided at the beginning of the Grand Finale, requiring teams to design, build, or adapt an Agentic AI solution.

4. Problem Statement & Solution

- Participants may choose a meaningful problem domain for Stage 1.
- The proposed solution must demonstrate genuine **agentic behaviour**.
- A basic chatbot or simple LLM wrapper will not be considered sufficient.
- The system should demonstrate capabilities such as planning, decision-making, multi-step execution, tool interaction, evaluation, or adaptation.
- Teams must be able to explain why an agentic approach is appropriate for their chosen problem.

5. Technology & AI Tools

- Teams are free to choose their technology stack.
- LLMs, APIs, open-source models, agent frameworks, RAG, databases, cloud services, and other relevant tools may be used.
- Generative AI tools may be used for coding, debugging, research, brainstorming, documentation, prototyping, and testing.
- Teams remain fully responsible for their submissions and must understand their implementation.
- Judges may ask questions regarding the architecture, code, models, tools, and design decisions.

6. Stage 1 Submission Requirements

Each team must submit:

- **Problem & Solution Brief**
- **System Architecture / Workflow**
- **Source Code / GitHub Repository**
- **3–5-minute Demo Video**
- **Runnable or Deployed Version**, wherever applicable

The submission should clearly demonstrate the working of the proposed system.

Teams must not include API keys, passwords, tokens, or other confidential credentials in their repository.

7. Demo Requirements

The demonstration should showcase an actual workflow of the system, including relevant stages such as:

Goal → Decision → Action → Evaluation → Adaptation → Outcome

Teams are encouraged to demonstrate how their system responds to failures, unexpected inputs, tool failures, or changing conditions.

8. Stage 2 — 24 hours Live Hackathon

- Only shortlisted teams will qualify for the Grand Finale.
- The Grand Finale will be conducted offline at IIT Bhubaneswar.
- A new challenge will be provided at the beginning of the round.
- Teams will be evaluated on problem-solving, technical execution, agentic design, adaptability, and decision-making.

Final Round Format

7 Minutes: Presentation + Live Demonstration

5 Minutes: Technical Q&A

The Grand Finale evaluation is strictly divided into two distinct components, each carrying equal weight (50 %).

Component A: Presentation & Defense of Round 1 PS (50% Weightage): *Participants will present a detailed pitch deck and defend the architecture of the solution they built during the Stage 1 online submission.*

Component B: 24-Hour Live Hackathon Build (50% Weightage): *Participants will build a brand-new solution over 24 hours on campus based on a surprise Problem Statement released by the organizers. Evaluation focuses on rapid execution, adaptability, and functional prototype delivery.*

Note: The presentations should cover the problem interpretation, approach, architecture, agentic workflow, live demonstration, key decisions, and results.

9. Live Demonstration Rules

- The final demonstration must be conducted **live**.
- Teams must be able to run and explain their system before the judging panel.
- Teams must explain the role of major components and the reasoning behind key decisions.
- Pre-recorded demonstrations, mocked outputs, or fabricated results cannot replace the required live demonstration.
- Teams are responsible for bringing the hardware and required environment necessary to run their solution, subject to organizer instructions.

10. Originality & Fair Play

The submitted work must be the team's own work.

The following are prohibited:

- Plagiarism
- Unauthorized copying of code
- Submission of another team's work
- Sharing solutions between competing teams
- Fabrication or manipulation of results
- Misrepresentation of third-party work
- Unauthorized access to another team's system
- Deliberate exploitation of the judging process

Third-party libraries, APIs, models, and datasets may be used where permitted and must be appropriately acknowledged.

11. Responsible AI

Projects must not intentionally facilitate:

- Illegal activities
- Violence or physical harm
- Fraud
- Harassment or discrimination
- Privacy violations
- Unauthorized access
- Malicious exploitation
- Other harmful or dangerous activities

Teams working with sensitive areas or personal data must clearly state relevant limitations and safeguards.

12. Code of Conduct

All participants are expected to maintain a professional and respectful environment.

Harassment, discrimination, intimidation, abusive behaviour, threats, misconduct, or deliberate disruption of the event may result in removal from the event and/or disqualification.

13. Disqualification

A team may be disqualified for:

- Violation of eligibility or team rules
- Plagiarism or unauthorized copying
- Multiple-team participation
- Submission of another team's work
- Manipulation or fabrication of results
- Unauthorized or malicious activity
- Misrepresentation of the solution
- Violation of the Code of Conduct
- Failure to meet submission requirements
- Any other serious violation of the event rules

14. Judging & Final Authority

- The decision of the judging panel will be **final and binding**.
- Judges may request technical explanations, demonstrations, or supporting information.
- The Organizing Committee reserves the right to address unforeseen circumstances not explicitly covered in this rulebook.

- The organizers may modify schedules, deadlines, round structure, technical requirements, evaluation procedures, or venue if required.

15. Event Details

Event: Agentic AI Hackathon

Fest: Tech Zephyr 4.0

Institute: Indian Institute of Technology Bhubaneswar

Team Size: 1–4 Members

Format: Online Submission → Offline Grand Finale

Prize Pool: ₹35,000

Registration Deadline: 10 September 2026, 11:59 PM IST

For registration, timelines, announcements, and further instructions, participants should refer to the official Tech Zephyr 4.0 communication channels.